

Understanding Coordinates Systems?

Astronomy Activity

TEACHER NOTES

Level: Introductory at Middle School or High School

Objective: This is a fairly basic introduction to vocabulary associated with various Celestial Coordinate Systems that will be used throughout the DSPIRA lessons.

Pre-Knowledge of Students:

- 1) Exposure to the Earth's Latitude and Longitude system for identifying locations of the surface of the Earth

Key Terms: Celestial Sphere, Celestial Equator, Celestial North and South Pole, Local Sky, Horizon, Zenith, Meridian, Azimuth, Altitude

Related Videos for Teacher:

[DSPIRA 2019 Lecture 2.1 Motions in the Sky Intro](#)

[DSPIRA 2019 Lecture 2.2 The Celestial Sphere](#)

[DSPIRA 2019 Lecture 2.3 The Earth's Motions](#)

[DSPIRA 2019 Lecture 2.4 More Celestial Sphere and Star Paths in the Sky](#)

[DSPIRA 2019 Lecture 2.5 Misconceptions](#)

Teacher Preparation:

- This is basically a vocabulary exercise. If this is a new topic for you, watch the video listed above

Activity Notes:

- Could easily be done in or out of class..